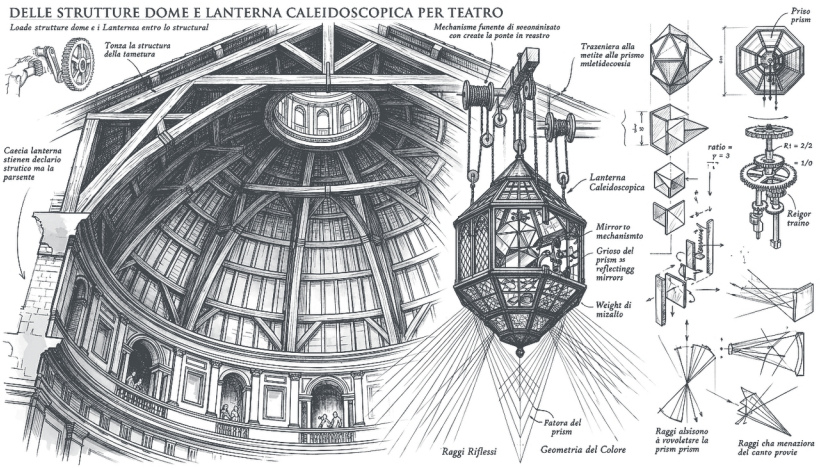
# The Kaleidoscope Lantern

Thirty paces above the empty stage, the great dome narrows to its zenith. Suspended in the gloom hangs the octagonal lantern-an intricate crown of brass, counterweights, and polished quartz prisms. From this dizzying height, the proscenium below is but a quiet shadow in the dust, waiting for the first beam of light.

Through the eight sides of the drum, morning sun and candle glow are divided into pure geometric harmonies. Turn the outer brass ring until the refracted rays converge upon the passage dial; the spectrum marks the pathway to the high terrace.




## Aurelia (1970)

When Pope-E set fire to the rigging below, the smoke rose thick into the vault, but the fire could not reach these heights. I climbed the iron rungs to the lantern drum while the bells were still sounding. I turned the prism vernier to the northern angle, casting a beam of amber light through the high archway to guide our companions across the terrace. Then I dropped the iron pin into the gear train so no stranger could turn the glass. The lantern held its secret while the theatre burned.

## Hermes (1998)

Silvia, the iron pin was still resting in the teeth of the drum when I arrived, covered in twenty-eight years of mountain dust. The quartz prisms are undamaged. When you solve the alignment in the lantern, the lock will release and the door to the northern terrace will swing open.

Beyond this dome lies the open sky. We are one step from the final stage.